

■ FREE GROWER RESOURCE · 2026

2026 Ontario Farm Grant Checklist + Deadline Calendar

Never applied for farm funding before? You're exactly who this guide is for. In the next three pages: whether you qualify, which programs pay for what, and the short list of paperwork that gets you application-ready.

65%

Cost-share available on some practices
— funding covers well over half the bill

Jul 8–29

The 2026 Agricultural Stewardship
Initiative intake — just three weeks long

5

Programs in this guide, from equipment
upgrades to per-acre habitat payments

■ WHY GRANTS ARE WORTH YOUR TIME

Every year, government cost-share programs help Ontario farmers pay for things they were probably going to do anyway — a more efficient grain dryer, cover crops, a windbreak, fencing for rotational grazing. **These aren't loans. You don't pay them back.** The catch? Most programs are first-come, first-served or have short intake windows, so the farmers who win are the ones with their paperwork ready **before** the window opens. That's the whole game — and this guide gets you there.

DO I QUALIFY? A 2-MINUTE SELF-CHECK



You farm (or own farmland) in Ontario.

Croplands, pasture, woodlots, wetlands and stream banks all count for at least one program below.



You have a Farm Business Registration Number (FBRN)

— or your farm grosses under \$7,000/yr and may qualify for an exemption.



You have a Premises ID (PID) number for your property — free and quick at ontariopid.com if you don't.



You've completed an Environmental Farm Plan (EFP) — or you're willing to. The workshop is free (details on page 3).



You have a project in mind

— anything touching soil, water, energy, trees or wildlife habitat probably matches a program on page 2.

Checked three or more? **You're closer than you think.** Nobody starts with all five — the last two are fixable in weeks.

THE MAIN 2026 AGRI-ENVIRONMENTAL PROGRAMS

PROGRAM	WHAT IT FUNDS	WHO QUALIFIES	2026 WINDOW
■ Agricultural Stewardship Initiative (ASI) OSCIA · Sustainable CAP	Cost-share for energy efficiency upgrades (grain drying, heating, lighting), erosion control structures, nutrient & manure equipment, soil health planning, organic amendments.	Ontario farm businesses with an FBRN, PID and completed EFP (4th/5th edition).	Intake 4: July 8 – July 29, 2026. Short window — enrol on the OSCIA Portal now.
■ On-Farm Climate Action Fund (OFCAF) Federal · delivered by OSCIA	Up to 65% cost-share for cover cropping, improved nitrogen management, and rotational grazing systems (fencing, water systems, forages).	Ontario farmers; enrolment via OSCIA Portal.	Continuous, first-come first-served until funds are allocated (2026 grazing intake opened Feb 24).
■ Resilient Agricultural Landscape Program (RALP) OSCIA · Sustainable CAP	Tree & shrub planting, native grassland establishment, wetland restoration, buffer strips, reduced tillage — up to \$150,000 per project .	Ontario farm businesses with an EFP ; land you own or control.	Open until funding is fully allocated — apply any time, sooner is safer.
■ Species at Risk Farm Incentive Program (SARFIP) OSCIA	Habitat creation & protection on croplands, grasslands, wetlands, woodlands — up to \$20,000 per project at 50–65% cost-share (+10% bonus for SAR-Watch monitoring).	Agricultural landowners with an EFP ; farms near species-at-risk habitat score well.	Annual intake, typically spring — first-come. Watch OSCIA's mailing list.
■ ALUS Community-delivered, Canada-wide	Annual per-acre payments (ongoing, not one-time) for wetlands, pollinator habitat, buffers and windbreaks on marginal or less-productive acres.	Farmers & ranchers in one of ALUS's 11+ Ontario communities.	Ongoing enrolment — contact your local ALUS coordinator (alus.ca).

2026 DEADLINE CALENDAR

JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY	JUN	JUL	AUG	SEP	OCT	NOV	DEC
	■		■	■		■					

■ ASI intake: Jul 8–29

■ OFCAF 2026 intakes began Feb 24 (continuous)

■ SARFIP: watch for spring intake

■ THE ONE RULE OF FARM FUNDING

Rolling programs run out of money, not time. OFCAF, RALP and SARFIP are first-come, first-served — “open” doesn’t mean “wait until winter.” If a project fits, apply the week the intake opens. Page 3 is everything to have ready before that week.

Program details verified July 2026 from OSCIA and program sources. Rules, rates and dates change between intakes — always confirm in the official program guide (programguides.ontariosoilcrop.org) before applying. Quadrat Studio is independent and not affiliated with OSCIA, OMAFRA or AAFC.

■ THE GET-READY CHECKLIST

Do these once, apply **everywhere**.

Almost every program on page 2 asks for the same handful of documents. Build the pile once and each new application takes hours, not weeks.



Environmental Farm Plan (EFP)

The gateway document — required by ASI, RALP and SARFIP. The workshop is **free** through OSCIA (in-person or online), takes about two half-days, and yours stays valid across programs. **Start here if you do nothing else.**



Farm Business Registration Number

Your FBRN, via Agricorp — most farms grossing \$7,000+ already have one. Grossing less? Ask about the **exemption process**; it doesn't disqualify you.



Premises ID (PID)

A free identifier for your farm property from the **Provincial Premises Registry** (ontariopid.com). Takes minutes; required on most applications.



OSCIA Portal account

Applications for ASI, OFCAF, RALP and SARFIP all flow through **osciaportal.org**. Create the account and complete the one-time enrolment form **before** an intake opens — not the morning of.



Basic financials

Recent financial statements or tax records, plus a way to keep **receipts and invoices** — cost-share programs reimburse against documented, paid expenses.



Field maps

A simple aerial or sketch map showing fields, watercourses and where the project goes. Reviewers **love** a clear map — it's often the difference between "approved" and "need more info."



Contractor quotes

One or two **written quotes** for equipment or work you can't do yourself. Line up quotes early — contractors get busy the moment an intake opens.



Join the OSCIA mailing list

Intake dates are announced there first. Subscribe at **ontariosoilcrop.org** — it's the cheapest competitive advantage in farm funding.

■ A NOTE OF ENCOURAGEMENT

Farmers with no grant experience get funded **every single intake**. These programs exist to be used — the reviewers want good projects on real farms, not perfect paperwork. Do the checklist above, pick one program, and send it. **The second application is always easier than the first.**

Want the maps, templates & walkthroughs done for you? →

The **Quadrat Studio Grant Toolkit** includes field-map templates, an application tracker, and a step-by-step **Course** that walks you from EFP to submitted application.

quadratstudio.ca

susan@quadratstudio.ca